little works.

Product family · Brand strategy · Build master brief

Consolidated working document | 16 October 2026

Purpose: preserve the concepts, decisions, functional requirements, positioning and build roadmap discussed in this temporary chat. This document is a planning baseline, not proof of market demand or legal name clearance.

01 Executive summary

Little Works is a proposed independent software brand for small, thoughtfully designed tools that make freelance work easier. Four apps are currently selected: tikk. (time), moola. (money), brix. (projects), remi. (follow-ups). Each should solve one recognizable problem, work well on its own and become more useful when connected.

Working umbrella tagline: “Little tools. Better workdays.” Broader positioning: “Work for yourself. We’ll take care of the little things.” Names are creative choices, not yet verified as legally or commercially available.

02 Decisions and product map

Product	Role	Includes	Working tagline
tikk.	Mac menu-bar time tracker	Client timers, overview, exports	Your tiny timekeeper.
moola.	Financial clarity	Moola + Stash + Pockit	Your money, made simple.
brix.	Project clarity & profitability	Scope + Briefly	Projects, piece by piece.
remi.	Follow-ups & reminders	Nudge + Ping	A little reminder goes a long way.

Naming evolution: Tiny Works was liked but its .nl domain was reported occupied. Little Works was then chosen as the umbrella name. For the project app, Brix replaced Scope/Breef/Bondo; for reminders, Remi replaced Nudge/Pingo/Poki. The four final working names are tikk., moola., brix., remi.

03 Brand & design system

- Brand personality: warm, playful but not childish; minimal, quiet, premium indie-Mac-app quality; practical rather than corporate.
- Naming: short, memorable, friendly, lowercase wordmarks with an optional final period.
- Each product can have a distinct accent and small mascot; all mascots should share illustration principles.
- Working color roles: tikk orange, moola green, brix purple, remi blue. Exact palettes remain exploratory.
- Typography: native macOS system type in apps; softly rounded wordmark can be explored.

- Use consistent icon geometry, motion, spacing, accessibility and UI language across the family.

Mascot directions

Tikko (tikk): tiny abstract round character, two eyes, perhaps feet; recognizable in monochrome at 16–18 px. Idle and active states should be visibly different without distracting motion. Moola: small finance-oriented helper (design open). Brix: character made from 2–3 rounded blocks. Remi: gentle blue helper with a subtle signal/antenna motif. These are design hypotheses, not final artwork.

04 tikk. — detailed MVP build brief

Promise: one click to start working, one click to stop. A native macOS menu-bar utility for freelancers who track time across clients; no web app, account or cloud required for the core MVP.

Core interaction

- Small icon in macOS menu bar; optionally show elapsed time next to icon when tracking.
- Click icon to open compact native popover with clients and current session.
- Click inactive client: start timer immediately; click active client: stop immediately.
- Click a different client: stop current session and start new one atomically. Never run two timers at once.
- Popover can close without interrupting tracking; current day and week totals are visible.
- Client management: add, rename, color, archive; keep historical entries when archiving. Optional hourly rate.

Overview & editing

- Separate compact overview window: daily, weekly and monthly totals, filters by client, individual time entries.
- Allow manual creation, deletion and correction of start/end time and client assignment.
- Export selected period and client(s) to CSV with Date, Client, Start, End, Duration and decimal Hours.
- Handle sessions crossing midnight by allocating duration to the correct calendar dates.

Reliability & platform

- Swift + SwiftUI, MenuBarExtra, local persistence using SwiftData or SQLite; lightweight MVVM-style separation. Initial proposed minimum macOS 14.
- Store timestamps, not incremented second counters; persist immediately; restore active session after app relaunch or restart.
- Default MVP behavior: elapsed sleep time counts. Later optional exclusion/idle handling.
- No Electron, no login, no network dependency for core use. Low idle CPU usage; light/dark mode, keyboard access, Reduce Motion support.
- Settings: launch at login, menu-bar timer visibility, seconds, theme, animations, export and backup.

Suggested data models

Client: id (UUID), name, color, hourlyRate? (Decimal), isArchived, createdAt. TimeEntry: id (UUID), clientId, startTime, endTime? (nil means active), createdAt, updatedAt. AppSettings: launchAtLogin, showTimerInMenuBar, showSeconds, animationsEnabled, preferredAppearance.

Onboarding

Two brief steps: “Meet Tikk. Your tiny timekeeper.” → “Who are you working for?” Add first client → immediately start tracking. No account registration.

Out of scope for tikk MVP

Invoicing, team features, mobile/Windows, AI, screenshots, employee surveillance, cloud sync, deep integrations, complex reports, subscription infrastructure.

tikk acceptance criteria

- Start/stop/switch are immediate and never create overlapping active sessions.
- Entries survive popover closure and unexpected app termination; restored state is correct.
- Time calculations and CSV totals match overview, including timezone and midnight edge cases.
- Menu-bar UI remains fast, accessible, legible in light/dark and usable without opening a main window.

05 moola. — finance app

Combines the original finance dashboard with Stash and Pockit. Key proposition: not just revenue charts, but understandable, actionable visibility into money that is actually available.

Module: Moola / overview

- Revenue, expenses, profit, unpaid invoices, expected income and month-on-month trends.
- Reuse the financial dashboard already built; inventory its actual features before defining the engineering scope.

Module: Stash / reserves

- Virtual pots for VAT, income tax, holidays, emergency buffer and custom goals.
- User-defined amounts or rules; do not imply money is physically moved between accounts.
- Tax estimates must be clearly labeled, configurable and country-specific where applicable.

Module: Pockit / available money

Illustrative calculation: cash balance minus allocated tax reserves, known upcoming expenses and desired buffer = estimated available amount. Avoid describing this as guaranteed “safe to spend”; show assumptions, pending payments and uncertainty.

Scope and positioning

Start as a financial companion rather than full bookkeeping replacement. Potential future accounting/bank integrations require security, consent, compliance and maintenance. Dutch freelancers are a plausible initial segment, while the brand can remain internationally legible.

06 brix. — briefs, scope and project profitability

Combines Briefly and Scope into one project workflow: from incoming brief through deliverables and budget to actual time and scope changes.

- Create client/project; collect or paste a brief, list deliverables, exclusions, milestones, deadline and feedback rounds.
- Set fixed project fee, estimated hours and target effective hourly rate.
- Connect tikk time entries to a project (requires project-level tracking/linking beyond tikk's initial client-only MVP).
- Show budget usage, hours remaining, effective rate and clear on-track/at-risk status.
- Record additional requests and change orders; estimate impact on fee and hours before accepting.
- Potential later AI-assisted briefing summaries; not essential to MVP.

Example: €3,000 project / 30 planned hours = €100 target hourly rate. If 48 hours are ultimately spent, realized rate becomes €62.50. The product should surface this drift early.

07 remi. — gentle follow-ups

Combines Ping (waiting on others) with Nudge (friendly follow-up actions). Avoid becoming a heavy CRM.

- Track whom the freelancer is waiting on, why, since when and suggested follow-up date.
- Use categories such as feedback, quote approval, missing files and overdue invoice.
- Show a simple "waiting on" queue and reminders; allow snooze, resolve and manual follow-up logging.
- Offer editable message drafts. Email sending and mailbox integrations are later features and should require explicit user approval.
- Tone: friendly, respectful, never spammy or aggressive.

08 How the ecosystem connects

Example journey: start project in brix → record time in tikk → brix checks profitability → moola shows financial impact → remi prompts follow-up on feedback or payment. Each app remains usable without the others.

Shared foundation — eventual target

- Shared optional identity, clients, projects, billing, integrations and design system.
- Independent app front ends and clear boundaries between time, money, projects and reminders.
- Local-first tikk should not be forced to create an account; cross-app sync can be optional.
- Explicit user permissions and clear data ownership, exports and deletion policies.

09 Business model — hypotheses, not validated prices

Product	Initial pricing experiment	Reasoning
tikk.	Free tier + ~€19 one-time upgrade	Acquisition and low-friction daily use
moola.	~€7–€12/month; test €9	Financial insight and ongoing utility
brix.	~€6–€10/month; test €8	Prevents project margin leakage

remi.	~€4–€8/month; test €5	Useful but likely lower standalone willingness to pay
Bundle	~€16/month for paid apps	Simple value story; verify margin and uptake

Illustrative bundle math at €16/month: 100 subscribers = €1,600 MRR; 250 = €4,000; 500 = €8,000; 1,000 = €16,000; 2,500 = €40,000. This excludes churn, VAT, fees, support, acquisition, infrastructure, salaries and taxes; it is not a forecast.

Commercial hypothesis: brix and moola may command stronger willingness to pay because they directly address profitability and financial clarity. tikk can be an effective acquisition product. Competition and acquisition costs are significant risks.

10 Market validation before expansion

- Interview 15–20 freelancers, especially Dutch creative independents, about their existing workflows and recent costly problems.
- Launch a Little Works landing page presenting four products with separate waitlists and a pricing test.
- Test willingness to pay with a credible preorder/paid beta or structured pricing interviews, not just likes.
- Measure tikk activation, 7-/30-day retention, weekly tracked hours and conversion to paid.
- For brix, test whether users would pay to prevent underquoting or project overruns.
- For moola, test whether the “available money” figure changes decisions and is trusted.
- Validate names through domain, trade name and trademark checks before public launch.

11 Suggested phased roadmap

Phase	Goal	Ship
1 — tikk core	Reliable menu-bar time tracking	Clients, timer engine, local persistence, recovery
2 — tikk useful	Complete everyday workflow	Overview, corrections, CSV, onboarding, polish
3 — moola	Reuse existing financial dashboard	Overview + Stash + Pockit pilot
4 — brix	Validate project profitability	Brief, fee/hours, budget health, tikk connection
5 — remi	Close follow-up gaps	Waiting queue, reminders, editable drafts
6 — ecosystem	Only after demand is clear	Optional identity, shared clients/projects, sync

Earlier rough implementation estimates (e.g. 1–3 weeks for tikk MVP) were brainstorming ranges, not committed timelines; re-estimate once codebase, developer availability and integrations are known.

12 Open decisions & launch checklist

- Verify Little Works and all four product names for .nl/.com domain availability, app stores and relevant trademark classes.

- Determine whether Little Works is the company/studio name, product publisher name or both.
- Audit the existing finance dashboard: technology, data sources, security, features, readiness for reuse.
- Choose initial audience and geography: recommended starting hypothesis is Dutch creative freelancers, with international brand language.
- Define data model boundaries between clients and projects, especially tikk → brix.
- Choose distribution: direct download, Mac App Store, or both; consider signing/notarization and updates.
- Determine privacy and security requirements for financial data, reminders and any future email/bank integrations.
- Choose whether to start with standalone licenses, subscriptions or bundles based on tests.
- Design and test icon/mascot concepts at real menu-bar sizes before investing in elaborate illustration.

13 Build handoff prompt

Build a family of small, thoughtful tools under the working brand Little Works: tikk. (native macOS menu-bar time tracking), moola. (financial clarity with reserves and estimated available funds), brix. (brief-to-budget project profitability), and remi. (gentle follow-ups). Start by shipping tikk as a reliable, local-first SwiftUI app with one-click client timers, persistent timestamps, a day/week/month overview, manual edits and CSV export. Use modular architecture and a consistent but restrained design system. Avoid unnecessary SaaS complexity. Preserve the ability to connect clients, projects and time records later, without requiring accounts in the initial tikk MVP. Treat prices, brand names and market positioning as hypotheses to validate.

14 Notes for continuing in a new chat

Paste or upload this document and say: “Use this as the source of truth for Little Works. First help me plan/build [product]. Distinguish decisions already made from open questions, and do not expand scope without asking.”

Status: conceptual planning only. No domain, trademark, competitive research, market validation, customer interviews or working software were verified in this document. “Little Works” and product names are provisional until checked.